

PREMIUM

Pre-Departure Checklist

From e-visa approved to clearing UAE immigration

2-4 weeks before departure

- Confirm your e-visa approval and double-check every detail against your passport
- Check your passport's remaining validity - at least 6 months beyond your entry date
- Confirm your health insurance is active and covers your full stay
- Confirm flights and accommodation

The week before

- Print your e-visa document and keep a digital copy accessible too
- Save or print: passport photo page, e-visa, flight itinerary, accommodation confirmation
- Check any medication you're bringing against UAE import rules - some common medications elsewhere (including some prescription and even some over-the-counter drugs) require prior approval or documentation in the UAE, and penalties for unauthorised controlled substances are severe and strictly enforced, even for small or trace amounts

Cultural and legal notes worth knowing

- Local laws differ meaningfully from many visitors' home countries on alcohol (rules vary by emirate and venue), public conduct, and dress in certain settings - a little research on your specific destination emirate avoids inadvertent problems
- Public displays of affection, offensive language or gestures in public, and photographing people without consent can all carry real legal consequences, more strictly enforced than in many other tourist destinations

Day of travel

- Arrive at the airport with sufficient buffer time for an international departure
- Keep your passport and printed e-visa in your hand luggage

At UAE immigration

An immigration officer verifies your e-visa and stamps your passport with your actual entry date and permitted stay - this sets your real departure deadline, so note it carefully rather than assuming it matches your e-visa's outer validity window.

- Be ready to briefly state your purpose of visit if asked
- Overstaying is taken seriously and commonly incurs a daily fine that increases the longer you stay - confirm your exact permitted departure date on arrival and don't rely on assumptions